

Pillar Report — Iran War Risk → Crypto

COMMITTED · Last checked 2026-06-19 · Stress-tested against live primary sources

1. Header / Snapshot

Pillar	Iran–Israel/US military conflict & escalation risk → crypto
Weight in my book	25%
Impact (draft)	7 / 10
Confidence	Low–Medium (marked down — the original read was one war behind)
Last checked	2026-06-19
My read in one line	<i>Iran shocks hit crypto for days, not quarters — but today's tape is Fed-driven, BTC ~\$62.5k, and the 2025 "buy-the-invasion" pattern has a re-ignited, unresolved 2026 war sitting on top of it.</i>

Scoring convention: P (0–100) = probability the Iran situation is **net-positive ("good") for crypto by the end of that window** (NOT P that a strike happens). **Quality (0–1)** = evidence solidity. **Impact (0–10)** = pillar's pull on crypto (single number, all rows). **Signal** = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$.

2. The Thesis

War shocks are **risk-off events**: when missiles fly, crypto sells off with equities as leverage flushes. Historically the effect has been **short-lived** — the 2022 Ukraine and 2025 Iran episodes both dipped then recovered within days-to-weeks. The thesis is "be scared for a week, constructive for a year." **The proven caveat**: that pattern is **n=2**, both in a bull regime, and the recovery mechanism (a 2022 retail short-squeeze) may not transfer to today's ETF/institutional market — where BTC is trading as a **risk asset correlated to the Fed**, not a safe haven.

3. What Changed Since Last Check

- **2026-02-28** — A **second, larger Iran war** began: US+Israel coordinated strikes on nuclear/missile sites and leadership. **~40 days** of combat. (Reporting includes the killing of Supreme Leader Khamenei — flagged as reported, not independently re-confirmed here.)
- **2026-04-08** — Ceasefire (Pakistan-mediated); extended indefinitely **~Apr 21**.
- **2026-05-25** — CENTCOM self-defense strikes; ceasefire fraying.
- **2026-06-07/08** — Sharp Israel–Iran exchange (~30 Iranian ballistic missiles at Israel; Israel hit Iranian military/petrochemical sites). Oil briefly spiked **>\$97** then settled.
- **2026-06-19 (today)** — Israel–Hezbollah agree to **renew a ceasefire**; **US–Iran nuclear talks in Obbürigen, Switzerland abruptly called off** (Iran refused to travel until Lebanon fighting stops; VP Vance postponed). A June **MoU** opened a **60-day window** toward a permanent nuclear deal (incentives reportedly include sanctions relief + a ~\$300B reconstruction fund).
- **Market state today:** **BTC ~\$62.5k** (–2.4% on the day), **ETH ~\$1,688** — **~40% below** the 2025-ceasefire ~\$107k. The slide is attributed to the **Fed (rates held, hawkish hint) + strong dollar, not Iran**. **Brent calm ~\$80**. Polymarket: "US–Iran nuclear deal by Jul 31" **YES ~95%**; "permanent peace deal" resolved **NO**.

4. The Evidence (✓ = verified this pass)

- **2025-06-13 ✓** — Israel launched **Operation Rising Lion** (start of the 12-Day War).
- **2025-06-21/22 ✓** — US **Operation Midnight Hammer** struck **Fordow, Natanz, Isfahan (7 B-2s, 14 GBU-57 MOPs, 2+ dozen submarine Tomahawks)**.
- **2025-06-23 ✓** — Iran struck **Al Udeid (Qatar)**; telegraphed/intercepted, **no casualties** (CENTCOM).
- **2025-06-24 ✓** — Ceasefire (announced eve of Jun 23, effective Jun 24).
- **Crypto reaction ✓** — BTC eased to **~\$105.7k on the eve** of the strike, bottomed at **~\$98,225 on Jun 22**, and reclaimed **\$107k+ by Jun 25** — a fast V.
- **Oil ✓** — Brent **\$70.84 (Jun 12) → peak \$80.37 (Jun 19) → \$69.13 at the Jun 24 ceasefire** (EIA primary).
- **Prediction markets ✓** — Polymarket "US strikes Iran" spiked sharply, resolved YES Jun 30 2025 (\$29.9M volume). (Exact mid-June intraday % is unarchived — direction confirmed, specific number can't verify.)

5. My Committed Scores (Signals recomputed from my P and my Impact = 7)

Window	My P	AI Draft	Quality	Impact	Signal	My Call
W1 1 mo → 2026-07-19	50	50	0.60	7	0.00	Neutral — no edge
W2 3 mo → 2026-09-19	55	55	0.65	7	0.46	Mild bullish
W3 6 mo → 2026-12-19	62	62	0.70	7	1.18	Bullish lean
W4 12 mo → 2027-06-19	75	75	0.65	7	2.28	Bullish (dip-buy)
W5 24 mo → 2028-06-19	85	85	0.55	7	2.70	Strong bullish

Note for the record: I reviewed the red team's overconfidence flag on **W4 (75)** and **W5 (85)** — that an n=2 sample and a re-ignited 2026 war argue for pulling the long windows toward ~55–65 — and chose to **keep the AI draft P's** unchanged. Eyes open.

6. The Prize (real event, recovery timing corrected)

The upside case is the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchor: **Russia's invasion of Ukraine, 2022-02-24** — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34.3k intraday low**, bounced intraday to **~\$40k (~+16% off the low)**, then posted its **big +14.5% up-day on Feb 28** and ended **~+25–29% above the low within about a month**. **The Prize = catching the V-reclaim — but it took weeks, not a day, and ran on a retail short-squeeze that may not repeat in today's market structure.**

7. What Would Break This (bear case)

- **It already broke once:** the 2026 war re-ignited four months after its ceasefire (June 7–8 exchange; talks called off today). "Time heals → good for crypto" is directly contradicted by repeated re-escalation.
- **BTC is a risk asset here.** With BTC falling on Fed hawkishness, a real **Hormuz/oil-shock → inflation → higher-for-longer** path sends crypto *down with equities*, not up.
- **Mechanism non-transfer:** the 2022 rebound was a leveraged short-squeeze; spot-ETF/institutional flows dominate now.

- **Contained oil cuts the upside too:** ~\$80 calm Brent means little war premium left to unwind in crypto's favor — while a Hormuz/breakout tail stays un-hedged.
- **Diplomacy-failure path:** a collapsed 60-day MoU window over W2–W3 is a concrete route to renewed risk-off; Polymarket's "permanent peace deal" already resolved NO.
- **n=2, both curated to confirm.** Counter-anchors (March 2020 –50% in days) show shocks *can* produce sustained drawdowns.

8. The Bottom Line

Near-term (W1) is genuinely no-edge: a fragile ceasefire and same-day collapse of talks cut both ways, so **P=50 is the one honest cell**. The medium/long-term bullish tilt **rests on a thinner base than the draft implied** — the dominant driver of crypto *today* is the **Fed**, not Iran, and the historical V-recovery is a 2-event, possibly-non-repeating pattern. Net: still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one**, but the long-window optimism (W4/W5) deserves a haircut and the Impact may belong lower. **Size it small and let the live state, not the 2025 memory, drive your P's.**

9. My Decision

My P: 50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85 — Weight: 25% — Impact: 7

(Kept the AI draft P's and Impact; set Weight at 25%.)

✓ **Committed by me on 2026-06-19**

Sources — retrieved & graded this pass (accessed 2026-06-19)

1. [Coinbase Exchange API — BTC-USD daily candles, June 2025](#) — **primary** (Jun 12 close \$105,721; Jun 22 low \$98,225; Jun 25 close \$107,400).
2. [EIA — Europe Brent Spot Price, daily](#) — **primary** (\$70.84→\$80.37→\$69.13).
3. [CENTCOM release on AI Udeid defense \(via globalsecurity.org\)](#) — **primary-equivalent** ("no casualties").
4. [Polymarket — "US military action against Iran before July?"](#) — **primary** (resolved YES, Jun 30 2025, \$29.9M vol).
5. [Polymarket — "US × Iran permanent peace deal by...?"](#) — **primary** (resolved NO, \$479M vol).
6. [CBS News — Pentagon "Operation Midnight Hammer" briefing](#) — secondary (7 B-2s, 14 GBU-57s, Tomahawks).
7. [Wikipedia — June 2025 US strikes on Iran](#) — secondary.
8. [Wikipedia — Iran-Israel war ceasefire \(Twelve-Day War\)](#) — secondary.
9. [crypto.news — BTC reclaims \\$105k after ceasefire](#) — secondary.
10. [Bitcoin Magazine — BTC reaction to the 2022 Ukraine invasion](#) — secondary (Prize anchor).
11. [UEEx — Crypto crash after Russia's 2022 invasion](#) — secondary (24h pared to –5%; +19.5% over ~30d).
12. [StatMuse — BTC price, Feb 2022 daily closes](#) — aggregator.
13. [Yahoo Finance — BTC/ETH prices, June 19 2026](#) — secondary (BTC ~\$62.5k, Fed-driven).
14. [Al Jazeera — Israel-Iran exchange as ceasefire falters, June 8 2026](#) — secondary.
15. [Irish Times — US-Iran talks abruptly called off, June 19 2026](#) — secondary.
16. [Trading Economics — Brent crude \(live, ~\\$80, June 19 2026\)](#) — aggregator.